

have probably come to her with sob stories since she started working at the bar.

Freebie Points

At this stage, Meg has 15 freebie points she can use to purchase dots she couldn't afford earlier, allowing her to round out some of Saffie's capabilities the way she likes. She consults the freebie point table for relevant costs, then looks over list of things she's been noting for possible improvement during character creation. Right away she decides to spend five of her 15 points to purchase a dot of Intelligence, making her mind as keen as her senses. She puts two more points into her Chimera Background, substantially increasing Brum's abilities, and Pete makes a note to talk to Meg more about her companion and his personality as well as flesh out exactly what he can do in terms of game mechanics, using the system in Chapter Seven.

Inspired by this decision, Meg spends two points to purchase another level of the Fae Realm so she can affect Brum and other chimera with any magic she learns. Four of her remaining points go into purchasing another dot of Kenning and a fourth dot of Empathy. She notes that this means she will get to choose an Empathy specialty later on in character creation.

Merits and Flaws

At this point Dan reminds Meg that she can also purchase Merits and Flaws, as Pete has already told the group these Traits will be permitted in this chronicle. She only has two of her fifteen initial points left, but can earn more freebie points by taking Flaws. She immediately selects two one-point Merits: Lightning Calculator, reflecting Saffie's affinity with numbers, and Good Listener, reinforcing her empathetic nature. That exhausts her freebie points, but she can take up to seven points of Flaws to gain more freebie points on a one-for-one basis.

Looking over the lists of Flaws, she selects Bad Sight at one point, meaning Saffie wears glasses out of necessity. She also takes Curiosity, netting two more points, and giving her an irresistible story hook that Pete can't wait to use. Lastly, she decides that Saffie suffers from a mysterious "bad moon" Curse, perhaps related to a past life — if moonlight touches her bare skin, she temporarily assumes her Unseelie Legacy for the rest of the night. She asks Pete how much this Flaw is worth, and he decides that since it's a short-term problem and only takes effect when she's out in bare moonlight without artificial light diluting it, it's only a one-point curse.

Now with four more freebie points to spend thanks to her Flaws, Meg picks up a dot of Subterfuge and two points of Resources, addressing some earlier notes she had about things she wanted to purchase but couldn't afford at the time. Meg notes the effects of her various Merits and Flaws on her character sheet, and the freebie point phase is finished.

Specialties

Looking over her sheet, Meg sees that she has three Traits over four dots: Intelligence, Perception, and Empathy. That means she gets a specialty for each of them, subject to Pete's approval. For Intelligence, Meg suggests *System Analysis*,

explaining that Saffie is especially good at figuring out how systems organize and operate, whether it's streamlining bar deliveries or figuring out the proper method of advancement in a redcap gang. Perception is a tough one, but she settles on *Detail-Oriented*, which makes sense given her occupation and hobbies. Empathy is another tough one, as so many ideas might apply, but ultimately Meg selects *Private Conversation*, making Saffie especially good at reading people if she can get them alone. Pete looks over the specialties and approves them, and Meg moves to the next step.

Threshold & Antithesis

Meg takes a copy of the rulebook and flips to the Thresholds section; while she doesn't copy down the game mechanics just yet, she wants to see if any of the Thresholds jump out at her as being especially well suited to Saffie's personality. As a member of the Seelie Court, Saffie is more likely to have a Musing Threshold than a Ravaging one, but that is not an absolute guideline. However, looking over the Ravaging Thresholds quickly proves that none seem to line up with Saffie's personality, so Meg switches to the Musing list. Help Those In Need is an obvious choice, given Saffie's boggan nature, but thinking about her history Meg decides that Foster Dreams is actually closer to the mark — as evidenced by helping Harper build up the freehold and encouraging the bar staff to pursue their passions, Saffie is definitely someone who encourages others to chase what's really important to them in life. Meg marks down Foster Dreams as Saffie's Threshold.

For Saffie's antithesis, Meg tries to think of something that Saffie would find completely banal, but that she still might be called upon to do in her adventures. Meg decides that Saffie really hates telling people that their art is bad or even unsatisfactory — criticism is just too much like rejection for her. It's not something she normally has occasion to do, but sometimes the bar hosts live music acts, and it might fall to Saffie to hold auditions. Meg notes "being critical towards art" as Saffie's antithesis.

Spark of Life

At this point the mechanical aspects of character creation are complete, but there are still plenty of details to consider that will help Meg bring Saffie to life during play. One thing that comes to mind is figuring out some details of her appearance. While Amy is sketching Harper and the guys are coming up with detailed descriptions for Lucky and Colin, Meg wants to keep some of the details of Saffie's appearance undefined for the time being, at least until she feels she's gotten more of a feel for the character during play. She settles for more impressionistic descriptions of Saffie's mortal and fae forms instead:

Mortal: *Saffie is small but possessed of a surprisingly loud voice and an air of busy energy that makes her seem to take up more space than she actually does. She tries to dress in a more businesslike manner at work, but it usually winds up looking more casual than not, as she goes for comfort over style. Outside of work she usually wears clothes of her own design and is always toting a book or two in a worn messenger bag as well as some piece of her latest sewing*